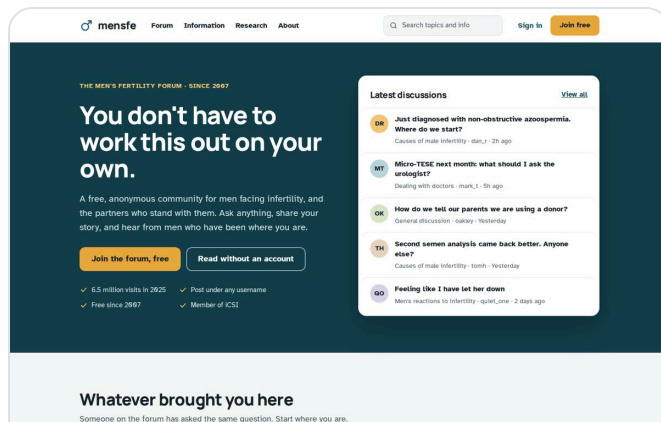


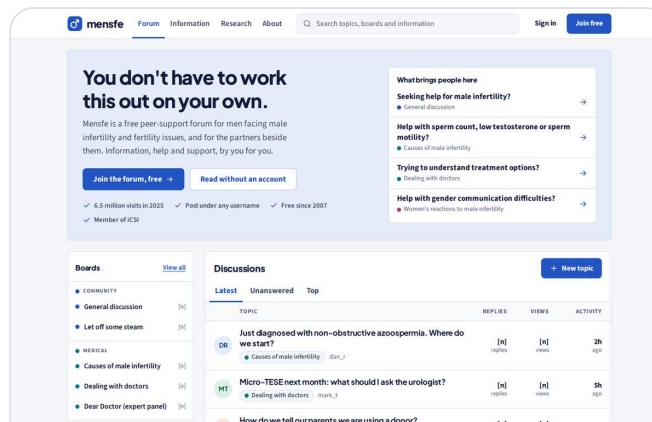
Three directions for the Mensfe forum

Each direction redesigns the same forum around the same content: a forum-first homepage, the board index, a topic page and a medical information page, all mobile-ready and built to fix the issues in the SEO audit. They differ in personality. Please pick one direction (or the parts you like from each) and we will develop it into the full site and SMF theme.



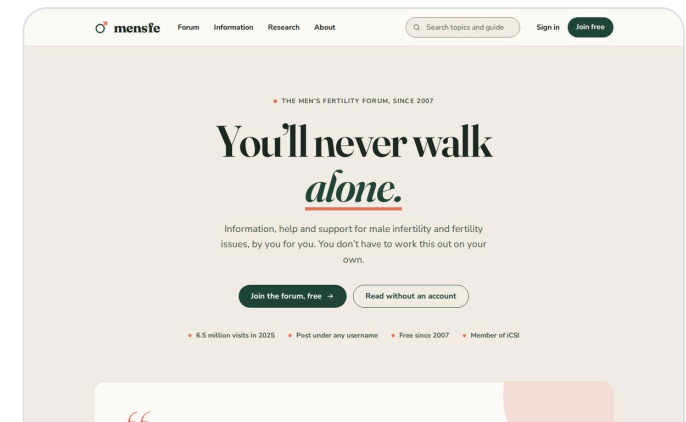
A • Harbour

Bold and branded. Confident, recognisable, a little dramatic.



B • Clear

Clean and clinical. Feels like a modern health service crossed with a forum app.

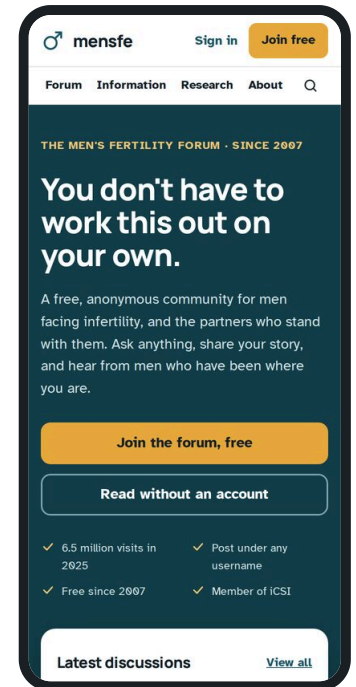
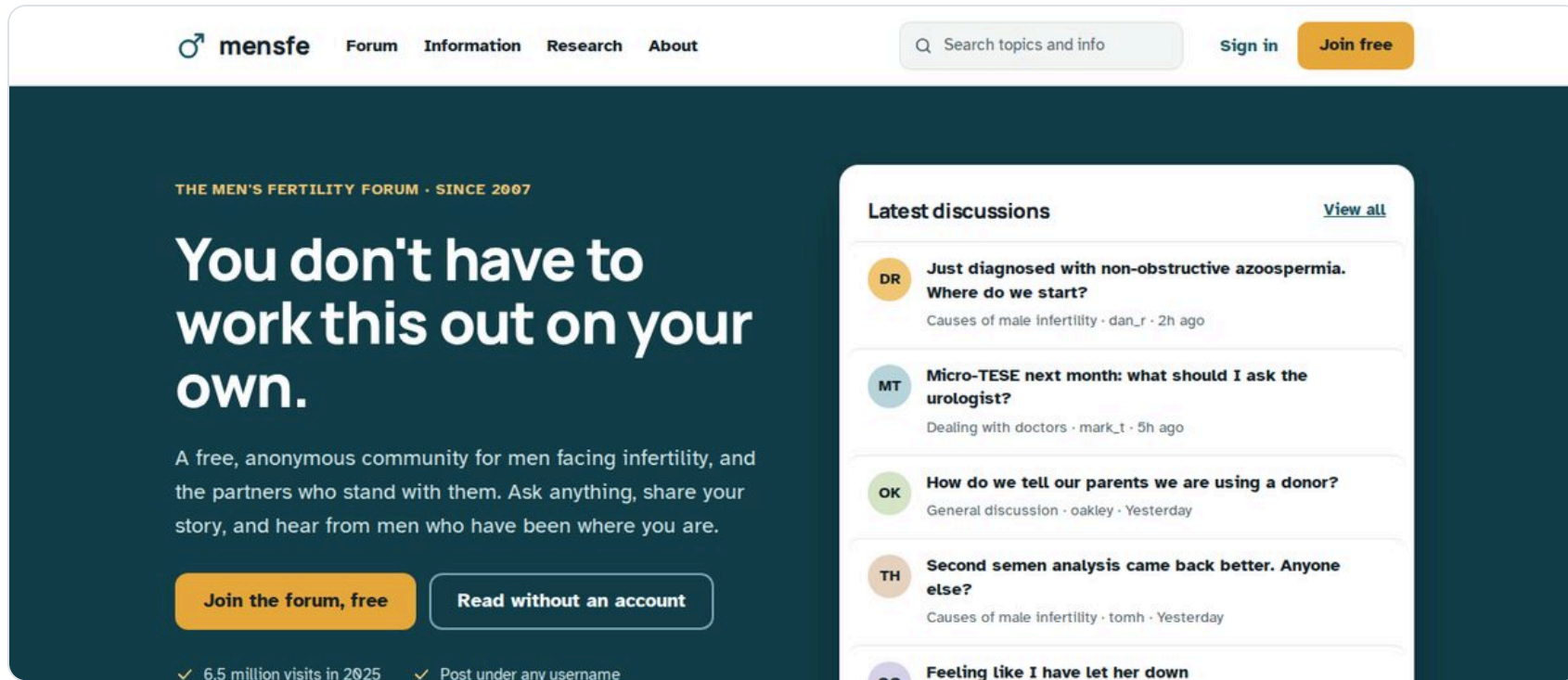


C • Stories

Warm and human. Leads with members' voices, like a thoughtful magazine.

All three share the same fixes: one clear heading per page, real text instead of text in images, latest discussions on the homepage, the founders' credentials on show, reviewer and date on medical pages, accessible contrast, and layouts that work on phones. Member counts appear as [n] placeholders, and sample posts are illustrative.

Harbour: bold and branded



Personality

- The deep sea-teal of the current shoreline banner, with a sunset-gold call to action
- A strong, memorable hero; the forum is visible from the first screen
- Best if Mensfe wants to look established and confident

Colour and type

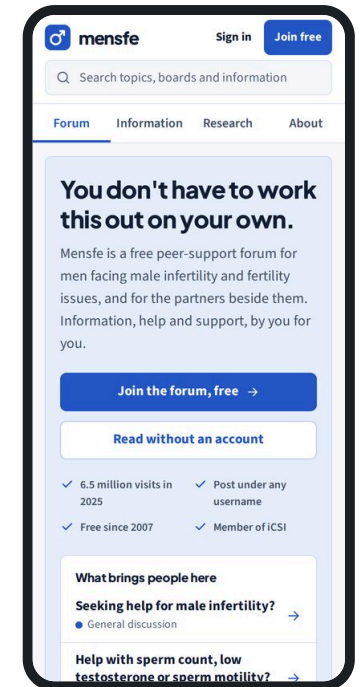
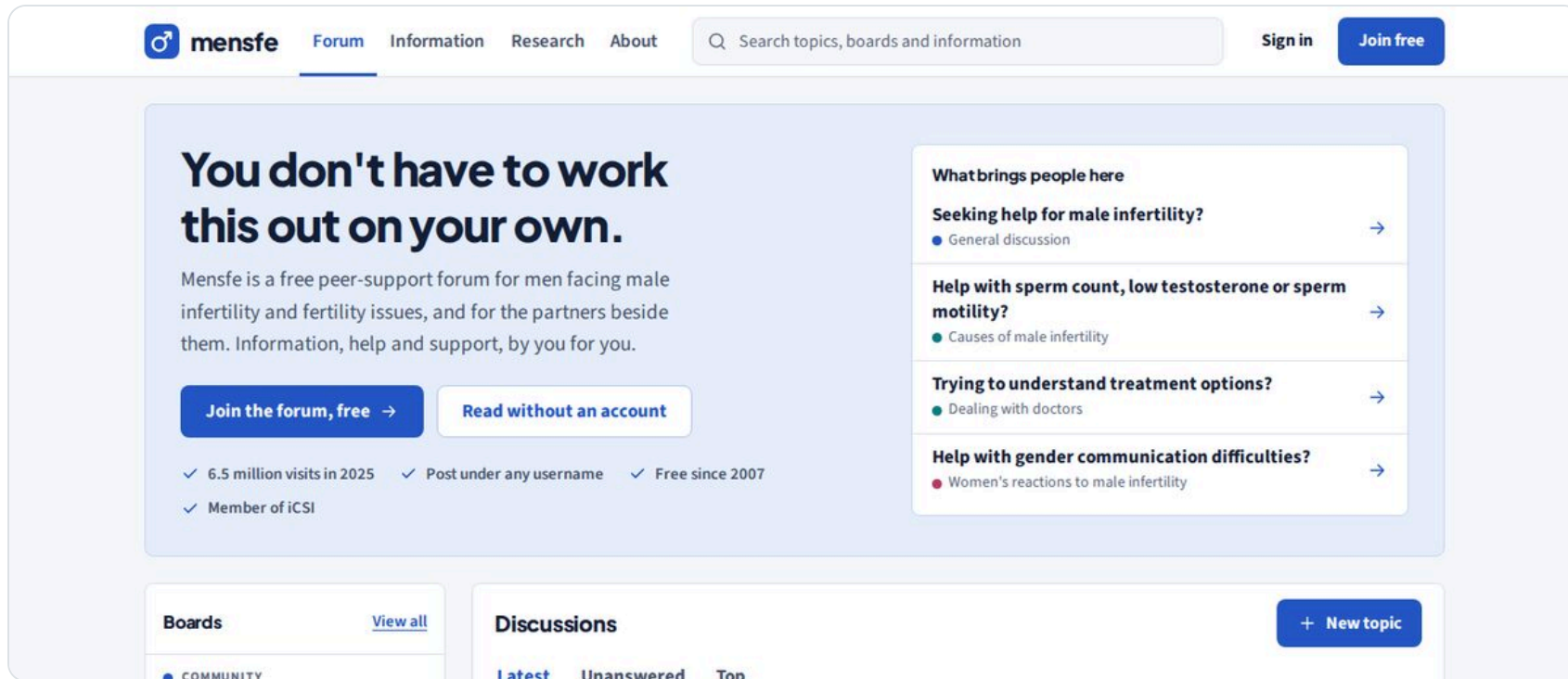


- Manrope headings, Atkinson Hyperlegible body text (designed for low-vision readability)

Watch-outs

- Dark bands are heavier on long pages
- Gold needs disciplined use to stay special

Clear: clean and clinical



Personality

- Calm, trustworthy and information-dense, like a modern health service
- A forum "app" layout: boards in a sidebar, a live topic feed with Latest, Unanswered and Top
- Best if Mensfe wants to feel medically credible and efficient

Colour and type

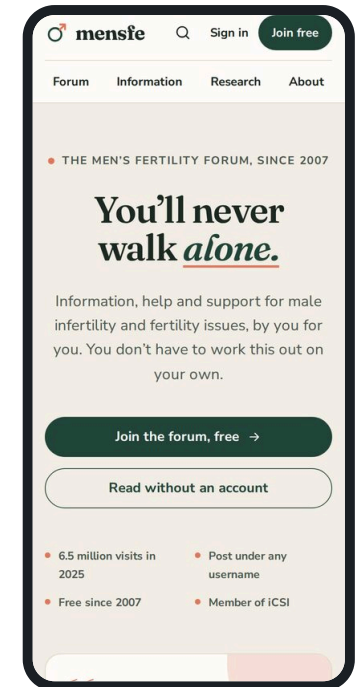
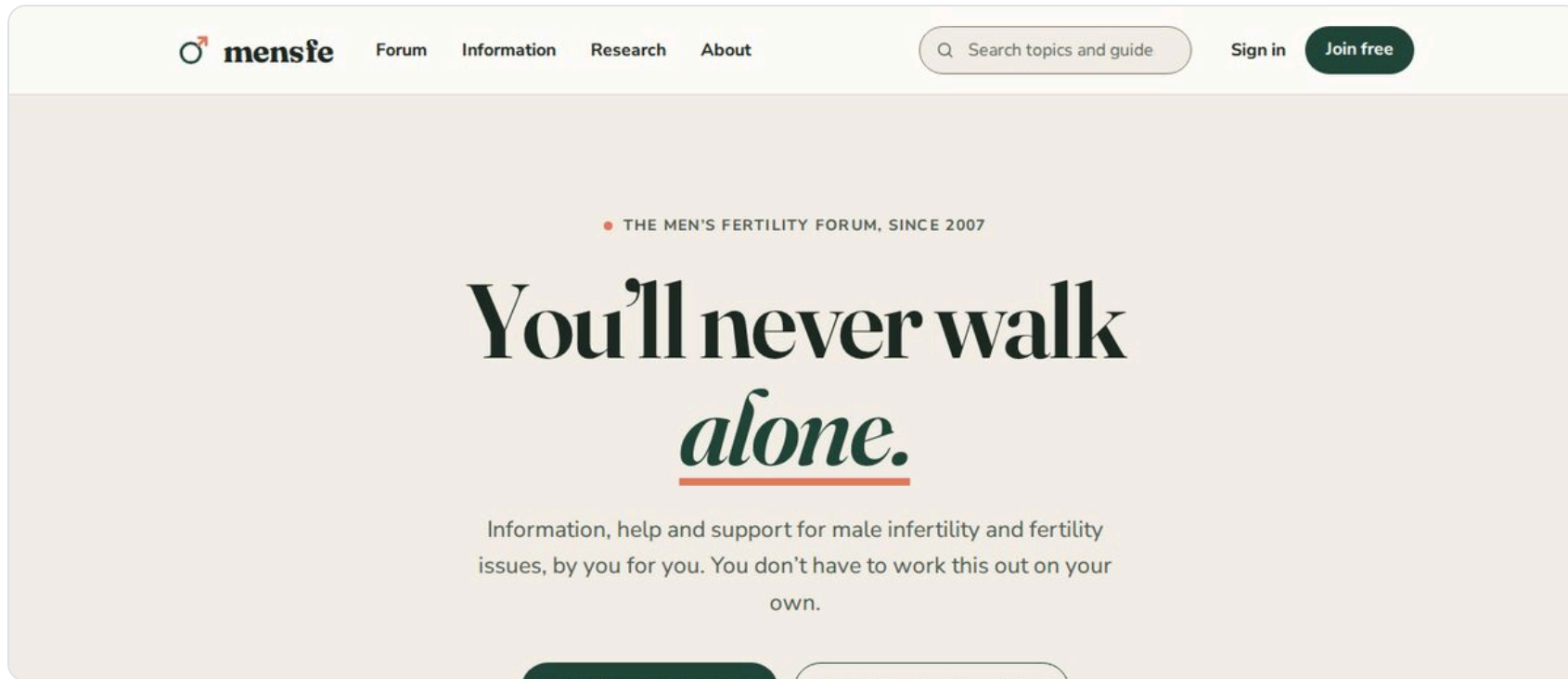


- Plus Jakarta Sans headings, Source Sans 3 body text

Watch-outs

- Can feel less personal; relies on activity in the feed
- Closest to SMF's own structure, so the easiest to theme

Stories: warm and human



Personality

- Editorial and reassuring; members' own words take centre stage
- Generous spacing and a serif voice for a reflective, magazine feel
- Best if Mensfe wants to emphasise empathy and the emotional side

Colour and type



- Fraunces headings, Nunito Sans body text

Watch-outs

- Needs members' consent for featured stories
- Less dense, so more scrolling on busy boards

How the directions compare

	A · HARBOUR	B · CLEAR	C · STORIES
First impression	Confident, branded	Professional, efficient	Warm, empathetic
Forum emphasis	Latest-discussions card in the hero; board grid	Live topic feed is the homepage	Featured member stories, then boards
Medical credibility	Good	Strongest	Good, more personal
Emotional warmth	Medium	Lower	Highest
Effort to theme SMF	Medium	Lowest	Medium–high
Accessibility	Very high (hyperlegible body font)	High	High

What happens next: once a direction is chosen, we design the remaining pages (sign-up, profile, search, private messages and the 12 information guides), build the responsive SMF theme, and implement the SEO and AI visibility fixes from the audits during the same build.

You don't have to work this out on your own.

Mensfe is a free peer-support forum for men facing male infertility and fertility issues, and for the partners beside them. Information, help and support, by you for you.

Join the forum, free →

Read without an account

- ✓ 6.5 million visits in 2025
- ✓ Post under any username
- ✓ Free since 2007
- ✓ Member of iCSI

What brings people here

Seeking help for male infertility?

- General discussion



Help with sperm count, low testosterone or sperm motility?

- Causes of male infertility



Trying to understand treatment options?

- Dealing with doctors



Help with gender communication difficulties?

- Women's reactions to male infertility



Boards

[View all](#)

COMMUNITY

- General discussion [n]
- Let off some steam [n]

MEDICAL

- Causes of male infertility [n]
- Dealing with doctors [n]
- Dear Doctor (expert panel) [n]

FEELINGS AND RELATIONSHIPS

- Men's reactions to infertility [n]
- Women's reactions to male infertility [n]

RESEARCH

- Current research on male infertility [n]

Counts show topics per board.
Reading is open to everyone; posting needs a free account.

+ Start a new topic

Discussions

+ New topic

Latest Unanswered Top

	TOPIC	REPLIES	VIEWS	ACTIVITY
DR	Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start? ● Causes of male infertility dan_r	[n] replies	[n] views	2h ago
MT	Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist? ● Dealing with doctors mark_t	[n] replies	[n] views	5h ago
OA	How do we tell our parents we are using a donor? ● General discussion oakley	[n] replies	[n] views	Yesterday
TH	Second semen analysis came back better. Anyone else? ● Causes of male infertility tomh	[n] replies	[n] views	Yesterday
QO	Feeling like I have let her down ● Men's reactions to infertility quiet_one	[n] replies	[n] views	2 days ago
SK	Another appointment cancelled. I just need to vent ● Let off some steam sam_k	[n] replies	[n] views	2 days ago
LB	How do I support him when he doesn't want to talk about it? ● Women's reactions to male infertility lucy_b	[n] replies	[n] views	3 days ago

[See all latest discussions](#) →

[Browse all boards](#) →

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[Join free](#) →

2

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Share as much or as little as you like. Many members start by reading for a while.

[Go to General discussion](#) →

3

Ask anything

Tests, treatment, how you feel, how to talk to her. Someone here has been there.

[Start a new topic](#) →

Information topics

Our information resources are free for everyone.

[All information](#) →



Male Fertility

How fertility works in men



Infertility

What a diagnosis means



Semen Analysis

Reading your results



Azoospermia

When no sperm are found



Varicocele

Diagnosis and surgery



Treatment

Options explained



Vasectomy Reversal

Reversal surgery



Erection Problems

Causes and help



Egg Donation

Using donor eggs



Sperm Donation

Using or giving donor sperm



Nutrition

Diet and lifestyle



Counselling Support

Someone to talk to



Medical guide

Medical jargon explained in plain words



Emotive guide

The emotional side of male infertility



RESEARCH BOARD

Current research on male infertility

Members share and discuss new studies, trials and news, and help each other make sense of what they mean in practice.

[Open the research board](#) →

RECENTLY DISCUSSED

New paper on sperm DNA fragmentation testing: what do we make of it?

[n] replies · 4h ago

Clinical trials recruiting men: where do you find them?

[n] replies · Yesterday

How to read a research abstract without a science degree

[n] replies · 3 days ago

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A Journey Through Male Infertility

Stronger Together

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Help with gender communication difficulties? →

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Discussions

+ New topic

Latest

Unanswered

Top

DR

Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

● Causes of male infertility

dan_r

🗨 [n] replies

👁 [n] views

🕒 2h ago

MT

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist?

● Dealing with doctors

mark_t

🗨 [n] replies

👁 [n] views

🕒 5h ago

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oakley

🗨 [n] replies

👁 [n] views

🕒 Yesterday

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tomh

🗨 [n] replies

👁 [n] views

🕒 Yesterday

QO

Feeling like I have let her down

● Men's reactions to infertility

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🗨 [n] replies

👁 [n] views

🕒 2 days ago

SK

Another appointment cancelled. I just need to vent

● Let off some steam

sam_k

🗨 [n] replies

👁 [n] views

🕒 2 days ago

LB

How do I support him when he doesn't want to talk about it?

● Women's reactions to male infertility

lucy_b

🗨 [n] replies

👁 [n] views

🕒 3 days ago

See all latest discussions →

Browse all boards →

Boards

[View all](#)

● COMMUNITY

● General discussion

[n]

● Let off some steam

[n]

● MEDICAL

● Causes of male infertility

[n]

● Dealing with doctors

[n]

● Dear Doctor (expert panel)

[n]

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[n]

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[n]

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● Current research on male infertility

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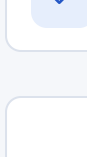
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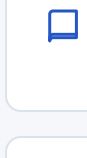
Start a new topic →

Information topics

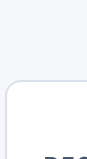
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All information →

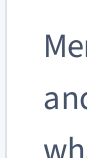
Male Fertility

Infertility

Semen Analysis

Azoospermia

Varicocele

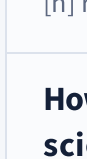
Treatment

Vasectomy Reversal

Erection Problems

Egg Donation

Sperm Donation

Nutrition

Counselling Support

Medical guide →

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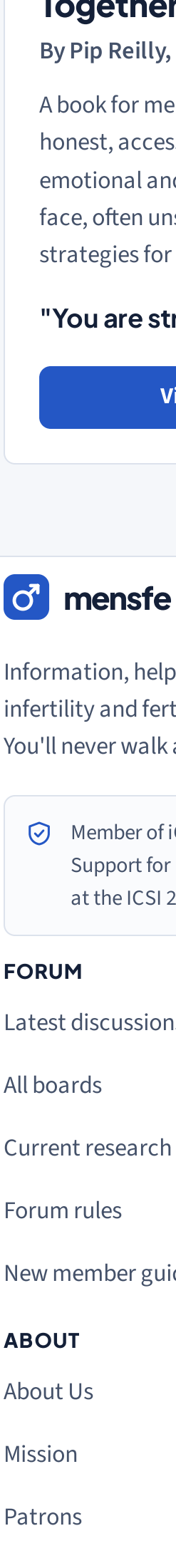
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View on Amazon ↗

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Forum boards

Every board, grouped by topic. Read freely; join free to post under any username.

Q

Search the forum

Search

+ Start a new topic

Community

	TOPICS	POSTS	LAST POST
 General discussion Anything and everything about male fertility.	[n] topics	[n] posts	OA How do we tell our parents we... by oakley · Yesterday
 Let off some steam Somewhere to vent when it all gets too much.	[n] topics	[n] posts	SK Another appointment cancell... by sam_k · 2 days ago

Medical

	TOPICS	POSTS	LAST POST
 Causes of male infertility Azoospermia, low count, varicocele, hormones and more.	[n] topics	[n] posts	DR Just diagnosed with non-obstr... by dan_r · 2h ago
 Dealing with doctors Appointments, clinics, tests and treatment.	[n] topics	[n] posts	MT Micro-TESE next month: what s... by mark_t · 5h ago
 Dear Doctor (expert panel) Questions answered by our medical panel.	[n] topics	[n] posts	HH Is it worth repeating hormone ... by hopeful_h · 4 days ago

Feelings and relationships

	TOPICS	POSTS	LAST POST
 Men's reactions to infertility How it feels, from the men living it.	[n] topics	[n] posts	QO Feeling like I have let her down by quiet_one · 2 days ago
 Women's reactions to male infertility Partners share their side.	[n] topics	[n] posts	LB How do I support him when he ... by lucy_b · 3 days ago

Research

	TOPICS	POSTS	LAST POST
 Current research on male infertility New studies, trials and news.	[n] topics	[n] posts	RK New paper on sperm DNA frag... by rob_k · 4h ago

Who's online

[n]

 people reading now

Live

 [n] members and [n] guests.

Members: dan_r, mark_t, jo_partner, tomh and [n] more.

Forum rules

1.

Be kind. Everyone here is going through something hard.

2.

Protect privacy: yours, your partner's and other members'.

3.

Share experience, not instructions. This is peer support, not medical advice.

4.

No advertising or selling.

Read the full rules

 →

New member guide

1

Pick an anonymous username.

2

Say hello in General discussion.

3

Ask anything, on any board.

Read the guide

 →

Forum statistics

Topics	[n]
Posts	[n]
Members	[n]
Running since	2007

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● Causes of male infertility

Just diagnosed with non–obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

Started by dan_r

[Start date]

[n] replies

[n] views

[← Reply](#)

[Follow](#)

[Share](#)

 **dan_r** Member Original poster

Joined [date] · [n] posts

3 days ago · #1

My wife and I got the results last week. Two semen analyses, both showed no sperm at all, and the consultant thinks it is probably non-obstructive. My FSH came back high.

I honestly don't know what to feel. I keep reading about micro-TESE and success rates and it is all a blur. If anyone has been through this, what should we be asking at the next appointment?

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Quote

Reply

 **mark_t** Member

Joined [date] · [n] posts

3 days ago · #2

I was exactly where you are three years ago. Write your questions down before the appointment, because you will forget them in the room. Ask whether they have checked your karyotype and for Y-chromosome microdeletions, because that changed what our options were.

And look after yourself. The first month was the hardest part for me.

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Quote

Reply

 **Mensfe Team** Moderator

Joined [date] · [n] posts

2 days ago · #3

Welcome, and thank you for posting. A lot of men read this board without ever writing, so this will help others too. Our [Azoospermia guide](#) explains the tests and treatment terms you will hear, and the [Counselling Support](#) page lists services if you would like to talk to someone.

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Quote

Reply

2 days later

 **jo_partner** Partner

Joined [date] · [n] posts

2h ago · #4

Wife of a member here. It is not your fault, and she is probably as worried about you as about the result. Talking to each other helped us more than anything the clinic said.

Helpful [n]

Support [n]

Quote

Reply

Reply to this topic

You are posting as your forum username. Please keep personal details out of your reply.

Your reply

B I

Share your experience, or just let dan_r know you have read this.

☒ Notify me of replies

[Post reply](#)

Topic progress

1/4 posts

Top of topic [Start date]

Original post dan_r

Latest reply 2h ago

Write a reply

Topic info

Board	Causes of male infertility
Started	[Start date]
Replies	[n]
Following	[n]

Related information

[Azoospermia explained](#)

[Surgical sperm retrieval](#)

[Counselling support](#)

This is peer support, not medical advice

Members share what happened to them. Please check decisions about tests and treatment with your own doctor.

Similar topics

Micro-TESE next month: what should I ask the urologist?

Dealing with doctors · [n] replies

Karyotype came back normal. Still waiting on the Y-chromosome test

Causes of male infertility · [n] replies

High FSH and no sperm: how did you cope with the first weeks?

Men's reactions to infertility · [n] replies

Azoospermia

Azoospermia means there is no measurable sperm in the ejaculate. It is a diagnosis many men have never heard of until it is theirs. This guide explains the types, the tests and the routes to parenthood.

 Written by [Author name]

 **Medically reviewed by** [Reviewer name, credentials]

 Last reviewed [date]

PR

RB

Mensfe is run by Pip Reilly, a professional fertility counsellor with over 15 years' experience with fertility charities, and Rob Barlow, a medical scientist who was diagnosed with azoospermia more than 25 years ago.

In short

- Azoospermia means no measurable sperm in the ejaculate. It affects about 1% of all men and around 10–15% of men with infertility.
- There are two main types: **obstructive** (sperm are made but blocked) and **non-obstructive** (the testes make very little or no sperm).
- Diagnosis uses repeat semen analysis, an examination, hormone and genetic blood tests, and sometimes an ultrasound scan.
- Depending on the type, options include surgical repair, sperm retrieval used with ICSI, hormone treatment in some men, or donor sperm.

1 What is azoospermia?

Azoospermia is the medical term for having no measurable sperm in the ejaculate. It affects about 1% of all men, and around 10–15% of men with infertility.

It is usually confirmed by at least two semen analyses. The laboratory spins the sample down (centrifuges it) to look closely for any sperm at all before the result is called azoospermia.

Key facts	
What it means	No measurable sperm in the ejaculate
How common	About 1% of all men; around 10–15% of men with infertility
How it is confirmed	At least two semen analyses, with the sample centrifuged
Main types	Obstructive and non-obstructive
Who to talk to	A urologist or andrologist

2 The two main types

Knowing which type you have matters, because it shapes which treatment options are open to you.

Type 1

Obstructive azoospermia

Sperm are being made, but a blockage stops them reaching the ejaculate.

CAUSES INCLUDE

- A previous vasectomy
- Infection or injury
- Congenital absence of the vas deferens, which is linked to cystic fibrosis gene changes

Type 2

Non-obstructive azoospermia

The testes make very little or no sperm.

CAUSES INCLUDE

- Genetic conditions such as Klinefelter syndrome or Y-chromosome microdeletions
- Hormone problems
- A history of undescended testes
- Previous chemotherapy or radiotherapy

3 How it is diagnosed

Your doctor will usually build up a picture from several tests. You may hear these terms at the clinic:



Repeat semen analysis

To confirm that no sperm are present, including in the centrifuged sample.



Physical examination

A check by a doctor, often a urologist or andrologist.



Hormone blood tests

FSH, LH and testosterone.



Genetic tests

Karyotype, Y-chromosome microdeletion and CFTR (cystic fibrosis gene) testing.



Scrotal ultrasound

Sometimes used to look at the testes and surrounding structures.

4 Treatment options

The options depend on the type of azoospermia and its cause.

Options by type	
TYPE	OPTIONS
Obstructive	Surgical repair, such as vasectomy reversal; or sperm retrieval (PESA, MESA, TESA) used with ICSI
Non-obstructive	In some men, hormone treatment; surgical sperm retrieval such as micro-TESE, used with ICSI
Either type	Donor sperm is another route to parenthood



Talk your options through with a urologist or andrologist. They can explain what your own test results mean for you.

5 You are not alone



[n] members are discussing azoospermia on the forum.

Men who have had this diagnosis, and their partners, share what happened next. Read without an account, or join free under any username.



Just diagnosed with non-obstructive azoospermia. Where do we start?

[n] replies · 2h ago



Karyotype came back normal. Still waiting on the Y-chromosome test

[n] replies · Yesterday



Obstructive after a vasectomy: reversal or retrieval?

[n] replies · 4 days ago

[Go to Causes of male infertility](#) →

[Join free](#)

Sources

- [Source 1 — e.g. NHS guidance on azoospermia]
- [Source 2 — e.g. NICE fertility guideline]
- [Source 3 — e.g. WHO laboratory manual for the examination of human semen]
- [Source 4 — e.g. peer-reviewed review article]



Mensfe is peer support. It does not replace personal professional, legal or medical advice. Always talk to a qualified doctor about your own diagnosis and treatment.

Was this page helpful?

✓ Yes

✗ No

Still have questions? Members who have been through it can help.

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